This soup should be sharp, sweet, and spiced—the juice of a whole lemon, one or two tablespoons of sugar, and quite a generous seasoning of salt and pepper are recommended.

beet and apple soup

SERVES 6–8 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 1 HR **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITHOUT THE HERB CREAM

1 onion, halved
2 garlic cloves
3 tbsp olive oil
salt and freshly ground black pepper
12oz (350g) raw beets, peeled and halved
1 potato, halved
4 eating apples, peeled and cored
1½ quarts (1½ liters) hot vegetable stock or chicken stock
1–2 tbsp brown sugar
juice of 1 lemon
2 tbsp finely chopped parsley, chives, dill, or cilantro, or a mixture
7oz (200g) crème fraîche, sour cream, or thick creamy yogurt

1 Briefly process the onion and garlic in a food processor. Heat the oil in a large pan over low heat, add the onion, garlic, and a pinch of salt, and cook gently, stirring once or twice, for 5 minutes or until soft. Meanwhile, process the beets, potato, and apples in the food processor.

2 Add the beets, potato, and apples to the pan and stew gently for 10 minutes, stirring occasionally. Pour in the stock, bring to a boil, then cover with a lid and simmer gently for 45 minutes or until the beets are cooked through.

3 Transfer the mixture to a blender and process until smooth. You may need to do this in batches. Season with the sugar, lemon juice, and some salt and freshly ground black pepper.

4 Stir the chopped herbs into the cream or yogurt, then ladle the soup into warm bowls and drop a big spoonful of green-speckled cream into the middle of the deep pink soup.